

A SMALL STEP WITH BIG MOVES

WITH A MID-LIFE FACELIFT, THE MERCEDES FLAGSHIP BIDS TO RETAIN ITS STATUS AS THE BESTSELLING LUXURY SEDAN IN THE WORLD. WE WENT TO GERMANY TO DRIVE IT

BY YOGENDRA PRATAP

While mid-life facelifts usually go beyond just cosmetic changes, the claim by Mercedes that the car is 50 per cent new, with over 2,700 parts changed or new, goes to show how seriously the company has taken the makeover: It has changed as much of the car as possible without actually changing the bodyshell.



While striking cosmetic changes abound in the front of the car, with a bigger illuminated grille and new headlamps, the biggest change is the move to various takes on the three pointed star. The starry grille is taken from the new Battery Electric Vehicles, while the tail lamp signature is echoed in the headlamps and is a take from the E-Class tail lamps. On the exterior, wheel designs have changed and front fenders have a new camera for advanced assistance features.

The interiors are mostly all-new, as is most of the software. On the inside, the infotainment system's screen makes its debut in the S-class, with three screens instead of the earlier two. The 12.3 inch passenger screen and the 14.4 inch central screen are behind the same glass panel, while the instrument panel is another 12.3 inch floating display. The biggest change is the software and hardware that drives these displays, powered by the Nvidia Drive Hyperion architecture that will have enough computing power for multiple upgrades to the car to enable autonomous driving in the future. The user interface now has the latest version of ChatGPT, Microsoft